UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE

Literary Criticism

Invitational B • 2020



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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • Invitational B • 2020

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. In prosody, the poetic foot composed of two accented syllables is the

   A) anapest.
   B) iamb.
   C) pyrrhic.
   D) spondee.
   E) trochee.

2. The recipient of the 2012 Pulitzer Prize for Drama for her poignant *Water by the Spoonful* is

   A) Beth Henley.
   B) Quiara Alegría Hudes.
   C) Tracy Letts.
   D) Lynn Nottage.
   E) Suzan Lori-Parks.

3. Rhyme that occurs at some place before the last syllables in a line is known as

   A) compound rhyme.
   B) internal rhyme.
   C) leonine rhyme.
   D) masculine rhyme.
   E) slant rhyme.

4. In an old theory of physiology, *either* the four chief liquids of the human body associated with the four elements *or* an individual's personal characteristics and disposition (both physical, mental, and moral) that are explained by his or her temperament or the balance of the liquids in the body, are the

   A) archetypes.
   B) duodecimos.
   C) humours.
   D) quartos.
   E) sigla.

5. The special type of realistic drama that was developed during the closing years of the sixteenth century that derives its interest largely from the exhibition of characters whose conduct is controlled by one of their characteristics or their disposition is

   A) comedy of humours.
   B) comedy of intrigue.
   C) comedy of manners.
   D) *commedia dell'Arte*.
   E) novel of manners.

6. Any expression so often used that its freshness and clarity have worn off is called a

   A) cliché.
   B) dead metaphor.
   C) pun.
   D) quibble.
   E) stereotype.

7. The author of *The Tragedy of Macbeth*, *The Tragedy of King Lear*, and *The Tragedy of Hamlet*, is

   A) Ben Jonson.
   B) Thomas Kyd.
   C) Christopher Marlowe.
   D) Thomas Middleton.
   E) William Shakespeare.

8. **Not** among the articulatory-acoustic-auditory elements of lyric poetry known as melopoeia is

   A) alliteration.
   B) annotation.
   C) assonance.
   D) consonance.
   E) rhyme.

9. A term sometimes used for *both* the late-eighteenth-century literary movement that focused on the historical, literary, and mythological traditions of particularly the Welsh *and* the late-nineteenth-century movement devoted to the preservation of the Gaelic language is

   A) the Celtic Revival.
   B) the Great Awakening.
   C) The Movement.
   D) the Oxford Movement.
   E) the Pre-Raphaelite Movement.

10. Popular in England while Elizabeth I reigned, the festive entertainment for the pleasure of the eye and ear that later found its greatest expression in the hands of Thomas Middleton and Ben Jonson is the

    A) burlesque.
    B) carnivalesque.
    C) dramatic monologue.
    D) masque.
    E) pageant.

11. The dramatist, lyricist, and author of *The Buried Giant*, *The Remains of the Day*, *A Pale View of the Hills*, and *The Unconsoled* who received the 2017 Nobel Prize for Literature is

A) Kazuo Ishiguro.
B) Elfriede Jelinek.
C) Kenzaburo Oe.
D) Harold Pinter.
E) Wole Soyinka.

12. The period in English literature between the death of Queen Victoria and the beginning of World War I that is characterized by a strong reaction to the propriety and conservatism of Victorianism is the

A) Augustan Age.
B) Caroline Age.
C) Edwardian Age.
D) Jacobean Age.
E) Victorian Age.

13. A genre that before the 1980s denoted, simply, informal conversation, but since has become a musical genre characterized by stylistically "improvised" rhymed verse sung or chanted to recorded instrumental and synthesized music is called (the)

A) blues.
B) calypso.
C) rap.
D) reggae.
E) scat.

14. A term coined by S. T. Coleridge denoting a willingness to withhold questions about truth, accuracy, or probability in an imaginative work is known as (the)

A) alienation effect.
B) jumping the shark.
C) moment of final suspense.
D) objective correlative.
E) suspension of disbelief.

15. **Not** among the English-language poets readily associated with the legends of King Arthur and his knights is

A) Thomas Malory.
B) Edmund Spenser.
C) Alfred, Lord Tennyson.
D) E. B. White.
E) T. H. White.

16. Material added to the text of, usually, scholarly writing and appearing in smaller type than the main text in order to provide additional information or documentation is called a(n)

A) abridgment.
B) annotation.
C) footnote.
D) reduplication.
E) synopsis.

17. The addition of explanatory notes to a literary text by the author or an editor—and by extension, a reader—to explain, translate, and comment on the text is known as

A) abridgment.
B) annotation.
C) footnote.
D) reduplication.
E) synopsis.

18. The form of fantasy in which scientific facts, assumptions, or hypotheses form the basis—by logical extrapolation—of adventures in the future, on other planets, in other dimensions, or under new variants of scientific law is known as

A) cyberpunk.
B) domestic tragedy.
C) dystopian literature.
D) manga.
E) science fiction.

19. Dating from the mid sixteenth century, originally a retort or sarcastic jest, and now, by extension, any witty saying, is known as (a)

A) antiphrasis.
B) equivoque.
C) litotes.
D) paragram.
E) quip.

20. The recipient of the 1937 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for her best-selling novel *Gone with the Wind*, with over thirty million copies sold worldwide, is

A) Pearl S. Buck.
B) Harper Lee.
C) Alison Lurie.
D) Margaret Mitchell.
E) Marjorie Kinnan Rawlings.

21. The period between the formation of the U.S. national government and the "Second Revolution" of Jacksonian Democracy during which time the United States emerged as a world force and enjoyed a rapid literary development is the

A) Colonial Period.
B) Federalist Age.
C) Realistic Age.
D) Revolutionary Age.
E) Romantic Period.

22. The instructiveness in a literary work, one purpose of which is to give guidance, particularly in moral, ethical, or religious matters, is known as

A) didacticism.
B) meliorism.
C) rationalism.
D) sigmatism.
E) vorticism.

23. The philosophical movement, characterized by both idealism and romanticism, originating in Europe and reaching the United States during the nineteenth century and featuring a reliance on both intuition and the conscience in artistic thought, is

A) dandyism.
B) existentialism.
C) philistinism.
D) pictorialism.
E) transcendentalism.

24. The revival of emotional religion during the first half of the eighteenth century in America defined

A) *la fin de siècle*.
B) the Great Awakening.
C) the Harlem Renaissance.
D) Transcendentalism.
E) *ultima thule*.

25. A cheaply produced paperbound novel or novelette of mystery, adventure, or violence popular in the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries in England is the

A) dime novel.
B) gothic novel.
C) penny dreadful.
D) potboiler.
E) pulp magazine.

26. The term that embodies the application of principles of scientific (either biological or socioeconomic) determinism in literature, which, in turn, characterizes a literary movement of the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, is

A) Darwinism.
B) meliorism.
C) naturalism.
D) objectivism.
E) surrealism.

27. The 1990 Poet Laureate of the United States and recipient of the 1999 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry for his collection *Blizzard of One* is

A) Galway Kinnell.
B) Ted Kooser.
C) James Merrill.
D) Mark Strand.
E) Charles Wright.

28. The nineteenth-century American author of *Little Women, or Meg, Jo, Beth, and Amy*, *Little Men*, and *Jo's Boys and How They Turned Out* and who often wrote under the penname A. M. Barnard during her early career is

A) Louisa May Alcott.
B) Kate Chopin.
C) Charlotte Perkins Gilmore.
D) Sarah Orne Jewett.
E) Harriet Beecher Stowe.

29. **Not** among the works of the nineteenth-century British novelist Jane Austen is

A) *Emma*.
B) *Mansfield Park*.
C) *Northanger Abbey*.
D) *Sense and Sensibility*.
E) *Wuthering Heights*.

30. The frequently ritualized state of being, either metaphorical or literal, on a threshold in space or time where, in anthropological terms, many social meanings congregate is known as (an)

A) aesthetic distance.
B) alienation effect.
C) epiphany.
D) liminality.
E) luminism.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-36 are associated with William Shakespeare's *The Tragedy of Othello: The Moor of Venice.*
Items 37-42 are associated with Kurt Vonnegut, Jr.'s *Player Piano*.
Items 43-50 are associated with Percy Bysshe Shelley's poetry (selected).

31. In William Shakespeare's *The Tragedy of Othello, The Moor of Venice*, the first person to attempt to put some doubt in Othello's mind about Desdemona with the admonition "She has deceived her father, and may thee" is

A) Brabantio.
B) Gratiano.
C) Lodovico.
D) Montano.
E) Roderigo.

32. In his aside, "With as little web as this will I ensnare as great a fly, "Iago is speaking of Cassio's

A) asking Bianca to copy Desdemona's handkerchief.
B) dalliance with Bianca.
C) kissing Emilia while greeting her.
D) stealing Desdemona's handkerchief.
E) taking Desdemona's hand and whispering to her.

33. Certain of himself and declaring, "My parts, my title, and my perfect soul / Shall manifest me rightly" is

A) Cassio.
B) the Duke.
C) Iago.
D) Othello.
E) Roderigo.

34. With an accusatory tone and claiming that "[t]heir best conscience / Is not to leave 't undone, but to keep 't unknown," Iago attempts to prejudice Othello against

A) bond-slaves and pagans.
B) Florentine arithmeticians.
C) the people of Cyprus.
D) the Venetian Seigniory.
E) Venetian women.

35. Surmising that there must be "some eternal villain, / Some busy and insinuating rogue, / Some cogging, cozening slave" slandering Desdemona is

A) Cassio.
B) Emilia.
C) Lodovico.
D) Othello.
E) Roderigo.

36. In Emilia's response to Othello's doubting her accusing Iago of lying, "[M]ay his pernicious soul / Rot half a grain a day! He lies to th' heart! / She was too fond of her most filthy bargain," the "most filthy bargain" is Desdemona's

A) divided duty.
B) losing her heirloom handkerchief.
C) marriage to Othello.
D) tourist-class ticket to Cyprus.
E) tryst with Cassio.

37. In Kurt Vonnegut Jr.'s fantasy *Player Piano* "the subterranean jungle of steel, wire, and glass" fills

A) Carlsbad Caverns.
B) Gottwald's farm.
C) The Homestead.
D) Ilium.
E) The Meadows.

38. While looking for a siphoning hose in the Plymouth's glove compartment, Paul realizes that

A) his car's inspection sticker is out of date.
B) his identification card has been stolen.
C) his old pistol is gone.
D) his tire gauge is missing.
E) his wife has taken his gloves.

39. Halyard has a very difficult time explaining the concept "average man" to the Shah of Bratpuhr, who immediately equates this concept to

A) citizen.
B) indentured servant.
C) peon.
D) sharecropper.
E) slave.

40. At The Meadows, on the second night of the annual competition, John Averageman, Old Man, Radical, and Young Engineer appear in a(n)

A) allegory.
B) comedy.
C) mystery play.
D) tragedy.
E) tragicomedy.

41. "He had never been a reading man, but now he was developing an appetite for novels wherein the hero live[s] vigorously and out-of-doors, dealing directly with nature, dependent upon basic cunning and physical strength for survival" describes

A) Bud Calhoun.
B) Ed Finnerty.
C) Rudy Hertz.
D) Bill Holdermann.
E) Paul Proteus.

42. Reverend Lasher works to explain to Paul that the "machines are to practically everybody" what the

A) engineers are to the managers.
B) Green Team is to the Blue Team.
C) managers are to the engineers.
D) white men were to the Indians.
E) Wrecks are to the Reeks.

Items 43-47 refer to Percy Bysshe Shelley's

England in 1819

An old, mad, blind, despised, and dying King;
Princes, the dregs of their dull race, who flow
Through public scorn,—mud from a muddy spring;
Rulers who neither see nor feel nor know,
But leechlike to their fainting country cling
Till they drop, blind in blood, without a blow.
A people starved and stabbed in th' untilled field;
An army, whom liberticide and prey
Makes as a two-edged sword to all who wield;
Golden and sanguine laws which tempt and slay;
Religion Christless, Godless—a book sealed;
A senate, Time's worst statute, unrepealed—
Are graves from which a glorious Phantom may
Burst, to illumine our tempestuous day.

43. The "old, mad, blind, despised, and dying King" in the first line of Percy Bysshe Shelley's sonnet is

A) George I.
B) George II.
C) George III.
D) George IV.
E) George V.

44. The figure of speech for which Shelley shows a fondness wherein there is a repetition in close proximity of words having the same root, as found in this sonnet's line 3: "mud from a muddy spring," is called

A) anadiplosis.
B) asyndeton.
C) polyptoton.
D) polyhyphenation.
E) polysyndeton.

45. The figure of speech represented in line 2's "dregs of their dull race" is the

A) allusion.
B) hyperbole.
C) metaphor.
D) metonymy.
E) simile.

46. Line 5 features a

A) conceit.
B) kenning.
C) metaphor.
D) paradox.
E) simile.

47. Line 12's "Time's worst statute, unrepealed" is apparently a topical reference to (the)

A) ban on atheism at Oxford University.
B) Catholics not being allowed to hold state office.
C) implementation of daylight saving time.
D) removal of English Civil War statues.
E) taxes on Central American fruit imports.

Items 48-50 refer to Percy Bysshe Shelley's

[One word is too often profaned]

One word is too often profaned
For me to profane it,
One feeling too falsely disdained
For thee to disdain it;
One hope is too like despair
For prudence to smother,
And pity from thee more dear
Than that from another.

continued

Shelley continued

I can give not what men call love,—
But wilt thou accept not
The worship the heart lifts above
And the Heavens reject not—
The desire of the moth for the star,
Of the night for the morrow,
The devotion to something afar
From the sphere of our sorrow?

48. In Shelley's "[One word is too often profaned]" the "antecedent" of *that* in line 8 is

A) feeling.
B) hope.
C) love.
D) pity.
E) prudence.

49. The species of end rhyme that pairs line 6 with line 8 and pairs line 14 with line 16 is

A) compound rhyme.
B) feminine rhyme.
C) leonine rhyme.
D) masculine rhyme.
E) triple rhyme.

50. The strength of line 5's "One hope is too like despair" depends on

A) ambiguity.
B) hyperbole.
C) litotes.
D) paradox.
E) zeugma.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism

Items 51-56 refer to William Shakespeare's

Sonnet 2

When forty winters shall besiege thy brow,
And dig deep trenches in thy beauty's field,
Thy youth's proud livery, so gazed on now,
Will be a tatter'd weed, of small worth held:
Then being ask'd where all thy beauty lies,
Where all the treasure of thy lusty days,
To say, within thine own deep-sunken eyes,
Were an all-eating shame and thriftless praise.
How much more praise deserved thy beauty's use,
If thou couldst answer "This fair child of mine
Shall sum my count and make my old excuse,"
Proving his beauty by succession thine!
This were to be new made when thou art old,
And see thy blood warm when thou feel'st it cold.

51. The rhyme scheme of Shakespeare's Sonnet 2 is

A) aabb, ccdd, eeff, gg.
B) abab, cdcd, efef, gg.
C) abbaabba, cdecde.
D) abbaacca, cdcdcd.
E) abba, cddc, effe, gg.

52. The assigning of arguably human qualities to abstract concepts, as in "all-eating shame" and "thriftless praise" (line 8) is an example of

A) aesthetic fallacy.
B) objective correlative.
C) pathetic fallacy.
D) reification.
E) zoomorphism.

53. The terms "trench[ed] field" and "besiege" ***and*** "livery" and "tatter'd weed" constitute (a)

A) controlling image.
B) dialect.
C) metonymy.
D) paradox.
E) synecdoche.

54. The speaker's use of the word *winters* when making reference to someone's age is an example of

A) aesthetic fallacy.
B) hypallage.
C) pathetic fallacy.
D) stichomythia.
E) synecdoche.

55. The proposed answer, "This fair child of mine / Shall sum my count [. . .]" (lines 10-11), suggests that the beauty of the person being spoken to will last if he or she

A) can answer a math question.
B) can count to forty.
C) praises what is beautiful.
D) produces offspring.
E) survives both the siege and trench warfare.

56. Thematic to the basic premise that the speaker offers his immediate audience is

A) beauty does not last.
B) fields often go to weeds.
C) lusty days cause one to grow old quickly.
D) thriftless praise follows shame.
E) youth gives way to winter.

Items 57-60 refer to John Updike's

Player Piano

My stick fingers click with a snicker
And, chuckling, they knuckle the keys;
Light footed, my steel feelers flicker
And pluck from these keys melodies.

My paper can caper; abandon
Is broadcast by dint of my din,
And no man or band has a hand in
The tones I turn on from within.

At times I'm a jumble of rumbles,
At others I'm light like the moon,
But never my numb plunker fumbles,
Misstrums me, or tries a new tune.

57. The diction of Updike's personified speaker in "Player Piano" serves to establish and reinforce the speaker's own, one could argue, necessarily static character through its reliance on

A) concordance.
B) consonance.
C) discordia concors.
D) onomatopoeia.
E) synæthesia.

58. The mechanical nature of the speaker's self-description is accentuated by no fewer than five

A) compound rhymes.
B) internal rhymes.
C) leonine rhymes.
D) masculine rhymes.
E) slant rhymes.

59. The clever rhyming of *melodies* (line 4) with *-le the keys* (line 2) is an example of

A) broken rhyme.
B) chain rhyme.
C) compound rhyme.
D) heteromerous rhyme.
E) macaronic rhyme.

60. The repetition of a vowel sound without regard to consonant sounds as found in line 1 is called

A) alliteration.
B) assonance.
C) consonance.
D) dissonance.
E) resonance.

61. The speaker's proud summation, "But never my numb plunker fumbles, / Misstrums me," (lines 11-12) meaningfully paired with "or tries a new tune," is a clear statement of a(n)

A) desire to sing as well as play music.
B) inability to create.
C) need for a tuning software update.
D) repressed fear of ivory.
E) wish to be self-sufficient.

Items 62-65 refer to Thomas Hardy's

Transformations

Portion of this yew*
Is a man my grandsire knew,
Bosomed here at its foot:
This branch may be his wife,
A ruddy** human life
Now turned to a green shoot.

These grasses must be made
Of her who often prayed,
Last century, for repose;
And the fair girl long ago
Whom I often tried to know
May be entering this rose.

So, they are not underground,
But as nerves and veins abound
In the growths of upper air,
And they feel the sun and rain,
And the energy again
That made them what they were!

*** a type of tree**
**** healthy (reddish)**

62. The setting in which the contemplative speaker of Hardy's "Transformations" is musing is a(n)

A) cemetery.
B) forest.
C) orchard.
D) prairie.
E) valley.

63. The subject of Thomas Hardy's lyric poem is (the)

A) cycle of life.
B) death.
C) Garden of Eden.
D) remembrance of things past.
E) spiritual botany.

64. The logical form of the speaker's thoughts as expressed in the words *may* (line 4), *must* (7), *may* (12) and, conclusively, *so* (13) suggests a(n)

A) analogy.
B) dialectic.
C) equivoque.
D) rhetorical question.
E) syllogism.

65. The three stanzas of Hardy's lyric poem are

A) sestets.
B) sestinas.
C) sextains.
D) squiths.
E) stichs.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie. Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Percy Bysshe Shelley's "[Tell me thou Star whose wings of light]," and discuss the effectiveness of the speaker's several instances of addressing aspects of nature in conveying the speaker's desire to find isolation or solitude.

[Tell me thou Star, whose wings of light]

Tell me, thou Star, whose wings of light
Speed thee in thy fiery flight,
In what cavern of the night
Will thy pinions* close now?

Tell me, Moon, thou pale and grey
Pilgrim, of Heaven's homeless way,
In what depth of night or day
Seekest thou repose now?

Weary wind, who wanderest
Like the world's rejected guest
Hast thou still some secret nest
On the tree or billow? *

* **wings**
* **cloud**

DO **NOT** DISTRIBUTE THIS **KEY** TO STUDENTS BEFORE OR DURING THE CONTEST.

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line arrows up ➔

1.	D	452
2.	B	
3.	B	255
4.	C	240
5.	A	99
6.	A	92
7.	E	534
8.	B	29
9.	A	79
10.	D	287
11.	A	
12.	C	165
13.	C	397
14.	E	465
15.	D	
16.	C	205
17.	B	29
18.	E	434
19.	E	396
20.	D	602
21.	B	195
22.	A	142
23.	E	483
24.	B	47
25.	C	357
26.	C	315
27.	D	605
28.	A	564
29.	E	560
30.	D	273
31.	A	1.3.334
32.	E	2.1.183
33.	D	1.2.36
34.	E	3.3.234
35.	B	4.2.154
36.	C	5.2.190
37.	A	115
38.	C	69
39.	E	22
40.	A	220
41.	E	137
42.	D	289
43.	C	
44.	C	372
45.	C	294
46.	E	445
47.	B	
48.	C	
49.	B	196
50.	D	349
51.	B	
52.	D	405
53.	A	108
54.	E	470
55.	D	
56.	A	
57.	D	337
58.	B	255
59.	D	232
60.	B	43
61.	B	
62.	A	
63.	A	
64.	E	466
65.	C	442

FOLD along the **three** longitudinal lines for ease in grading. ➔

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

DO NOT mark (cross out) actual **LETTER** answer; mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer to the *Handbook* 12e,

the Folger's updated *Othello*,

the Dial Press *Player Piano*,

and

Oxford World's Classics P. B. Shelley collection.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Shelley's "[Tell me thou Star, whose wings of light]"

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used by the contestant in a discussion of these poems include

alliteration,
apostrophe,
diction (word choice),
imagery,
irony,
kenning,
metaphor,
rhetorical question,
rhyme scheme,
sigmatism,
simile, and
tone.

The observant student will notice that each stanza is an apostrophe addressing an element of nature. The speaker's perhaps wistful tone is marked by three introductory supplicatory imperatives, which, thus, characterizes the speaker's queries regarding several favored loci of respite: the Star's "cavern of night" (line 3), the Moon's "depth of night or day" (7), and the wind's "secret nest" (11).

The imagery of each stanzaic query suggests a longing for something similarly remote on the part of the speaker himself, the speaker's implied, unstated, requests pointing to something in the way of envy for the Star's, the Moon's, and the wind's being able to seclude themselves, at least at some point, from human awareness.

The young writer might make something of the receding distance associated with each element of nature to which he directs his question: the Star, the Moon, and the wind. The next possible site of isolation might be one within the reach of the speaker.